

Transcript 6

So, it's good to have you here. Thanks so much for participating. I really appreciate it. And just kind of to start off, we're going to do a little interview to go a bit more in-depth about homesickness and voice recordings. Already you saw something in the questionnaire, of course, and today we're going to be talking about what you think about certain aspects. And just to start off, how are you feeling today?

Okay. Just as a context, I moved to Amsterdam maybe 10-2 weeks ago.

Okay. Yes.

So, maybe these days I'm kind of adapting, same as my experience with all the moving around, housing, hostel, and all these other things. Yeah. But, yeah. Just because today I'm switching room. So, I'm actually going to a hotel for today. And then on Monday I'm going to be in my room. Yes. I'm a bit like a lower residence. Yes. A bit hectic.

I understand. And to confirm, could you tell me where you're from originally?

I am from Greece. More specifically from Greece in the south of the island. Yes. The city of Hania.

Okay. And where do you currently live? And you already said it.

Yes, I live in Amsterdam. I live next to the Science Park.

Yes, next to Science Park. And what do you consider to be home?

What do I consider to be home? Okay. I guess it's connected to a physical place. Or when you say the word home, I connected to a physical place, which is my hometown. Yes. So, that's connected to many factors. As a child, I grew up there. Or kind of, yeah. It's more specific to be honest. It's connected. I connected to where I'm from. The village is where I'm from. Yes. And, yeah. If you would ask me about it, consider home. I would say that specific village. And that specific house there.

Yes, exactly. Okay. And do you remember a moment when you were the most homesick in your life?

Okay. That would probably have to be maybe the first time I left Greece to sort of pursue like an internship. Or something I had to do for my bachelor's. And maybe I was like around 25 years old. Yes.

Yeah. Okay. So, and what location did you miss then?

I think it was maybe not so much connected with the location in itself. I mean, there was a location, but it was also all the stuff around it. It was connected to relationships and friends. Yes. And family. And these sort of things. That you left behind.

Yeah. Yes. You leave all those things behind. Yes. I understand. Okay. So, now I kind of want to go on to voice recordings and then specifically how personal or generic they are to you. And what I mean by that is a personal voice recording would be one that resonates with you personally. So, it does not necessarily have to come from someone that's close to you, but it needs to have a personal connection. So, it could be linguistic, historical, cultural, anything that makes it feel connected to you. And the generic voice recording is then the opposite of that. So, it doesn't have the personal connection.

Okay.

All right. So, if you would think about voice recordings in general or any type of audio that has voice, which types of voice recordings do you think could feel more personal to you and why?

I guess maybe voice recordings that are somehow connected to maybe... No, there is something maybe even to clarify. When you mention voice recordings... Yes. Do you mean whatever those can be even like educational part of a documentary or part of a radio show or part of a... Are those like pre-recorded sounds that are played afterwards? And this can also be like... As I said, the radio show that's something that is live.

Yes. It's a recording. It doesn't really matter where it's from or if it's live or not as long as it's mainly based on voice. So, the voice is the primary component then that's okay.

Yes. What I get... If there is a voice recording or a voice sample or whatever that probably I would get attached to that or... If there is a voice that is more personal that probably has to be something that is sharing maybe... Some cultural concerns or maybe addressing some certain ethical issues or something that maybe even... I feel connected to that maybe it's connected to my home country or specifically to my city. Yes. So, that's what I usually have the tendency to listen to radio like... Now, right now I'm in Amsterdam. I listen to local radio from my hometown. I don't even listen to radio from Athens or not even radio from Amsterdam or Netherlands. I try sometimes to explore this area but I usually the first thing I do in the morning, I put the radio show for my hometown.

Yes, I understand. Yes. And then in contrast to that, what do you think would be making a voice recording more generic?

When you say generic, probably that has to be something that is like a tutorial about something or explaining something technical that is part of my work maybe. I don't have some sort of strong sentiment towards that it's not connected to any sort of ethical dilemmas or issues. Yes. Maybe... It depends on the... I guess it depends on the context. What is it about? So, I'm stripping out now who is doing the narration or... I'm just looking at the content in itself. Yes. So, I would consider that I would feel less attached to maybe recording that it's about how to do something or how something is achieved, you know, like it's purely engineering or...

Yes. Yeah. So, you would say such a recording could be very useful for you but it's not that personal.

Exactly. Exactly. I would probably keep it on my notes or whatever. I'd like to help them to write a paper or to write a card or whatever. But I would sort of recall it in a sentimental sense or like emotional sense or...

Yes. Yes, I understand completely. And so, during this interview, I also want to send you in the chat another questionnaire. I will send you the link right now. And the idea is to just keep this open during the rest of the interview.

Okay.

And it consists of 15 items. And this is based on the listening test that we're going to do. So, what you're going to see, first of all, is a question to just fit in the same email address or phone number that you filled in for the first questionnaire. And then... You can...

Should I do that?

Yes, you can fill that in now. And then what I'm going to do next is I'm going to let you hear five voice recordings. And you can fill in the skills based on the voice recording. So, the first kind of item you see is someone from a different country talking in a different language you're not very familiar with about the weather. I'm going to let you hear a voice recording that corresponds with that description. And once you... Once you have your opinion ready, you can tell me to go to the next recording. And that is also the next item. After the first five, we go back to the interview. And then we do that back and forth two more times. And if anything is unclear, you can just let me know.

Okay. So, I filled in my mail and I think I'm at the first.. Yeah I am.. Yes.

So, I'm going to let you hear the recording and then you can fill in how generic or personal it feels to you.

So, for the one recording, it's these five items or is it like different recordings for each?

Yes, each item is a different recording.

Okay. Okay.

So, you can also please tell me if it's unclear, you cannot hear it, anything like that. Okay. Are you ready for the first recording?

Uh, yeah. Do I need to actually read the question first or do I do that afterwards?

That's okay. You can just leave it be for this for now. I can just let you hear it.

[Voice recording audio: recording 1]

All right. So, you can fill in the first one and then we can go to the next.

Okay. It's French, right? Or something like that?

Yes, it's French.

I don't speak French. I don't know what they've discussed about.

That's okay.

So, clarification here. So, how personal or generic does that feel? In a sense, how... If I could empathize with a person or if it's sort of like something that I would care about?

Yeah. So, if it kind of resonates with you. So, maybe what you said about you care about it, you feel it's close to you. Anything like that?

Okay.

[Voice recording audio: recording 2]

[Voice recording audio: recording 7]

I have to think about it now. It's a bit weird because, before there were two languages, one language that I was being unfamiliar, now there's my language.

Yes.

He talks about the weather, it's not that I have something personal about the weather or whatever, or if I feel attached to it, but I feel a bit weird in the sense that I felt attached because it was my language, but the context is purely generic or let's say it's just the weather.

Yes.

If it was a historical recording maybe in my language I would be interested, maybe now ..

So would you say right now it kind of feels a bit personal but maybe not that much meaning or usefulness for you?

Exactly. I just could not connect to it.

Ready for the next one?

Yes

[Voice recording audio: recording 14]

Okay

[Voice recording audio: recording 21]

Okay. So now you've filled in those five. Then you can keep the tab open. We're going to go back to the interview now.

Alright.

So based on these five recordings and according to you, do you think there were specific elements of the situations and the context that made it more or less personal or generic? And if so, which elements made it personal or made it more generic?

Okay. When it comes to the French part, I guess because I can't understand the context and I can't understand what it was about, maybe I would say that it felt more personal if the person was passionate about it.

Yes.

Or they could have talked about the recipe or whatever, how to cook something French. But if they sounded like really passionate about the recipe and shouting or whatever, I guess I would have connected that to more personal and sort of an excitement or passionate feeling about talking about something. But if it was the opposite, talking about something that the contenting itself would be personal, but the intensity of the voice or something that is not, if the intensity was not that high, I wouldn't perceive it as personal. So I was really focusing when it came to that

language, I was really focusing on the, how passionate or how intense that recording was.

Yes.

Now coming to my native language, I guess I would feel more personal or more attached to something that was about politics or something that was about a view or an opinion about something. Now, for example, you chose Tsipras, who is like a politician and she was sharing about your opinion that she has about. I don't know if it was a pre-election thing, but what it was pulled from. I was more connected with that rather than the weather or even the one that was a holiday that was more connected personally, but more on a personal level, but it was a bit more positive.

Yes.

We were just sharing how holidays are being spent with the family when they are cooking and how they're done. I felt more in the same situation, I would say that I felt personal to both things, but I would say that with the politics, I was more positively inclined. I didn't have any negative feelings about it. But with the politics, it's always like something, you kind of, something, another area of your brain is deciphering it. You're thinking, okay, do I agree? Do I not agree with what they say? So, those were the feelings that I had while I was listening to. Yeah. I don't know if that answered your question.

Yes, it definitely does. So next up is about the meaningfulness of voice recordings, and it's a bit of a nuanced difference. So, I mean, whether a voice recording feels in any way important or relevant to you, and it could actually mean something to you emotionally, for example, but it could also feel important without emotions, just reminding you of something significant. and a voice recording could also, for example, be very personal and not meaningful at all, but it could also be not personal and very meaningful. So it's a small difference.

I can't really understand what could be meaningful but not important because it's a purely subjective thing. If it's meaningful, then I would say that it's important, but it's to me.

Yes.

So, it's always, so I don't know, I cannot understand what something would be meaningful and not important, or I cannot recall something that I would think.

Well, let's see, maybe, and I don't want to be too suggestive, of course, but maybe what you just said about the French recordings, like the intonation, the tone of voice, it can be very positive and maybe endearing, and then it feels a bit more, more like

personal, but it's not that meaningful because you don't know the context, you don't know what they're talking about. That's one example and you could have more of those types of situations, of course.

All right. By this, okay, I see what you mean by meaningful. Yes. Yeah. So, it could also be that, for example, a topic is very meaningful, but it might not feel that personal.

Yes, but you can just fill it in the way you think and if it's very overlapping, then that's, of course, okay as well.

Okay, so I should go to the questionnaire and press next?

Yes, and then there are going to be the same five statements, you will hear the same five recordings again and then you can fill them in this time based on how meaningful or not they feel to you.

Okay.

[Voice recording audio: recording 1]

Okay. So just to clarify, I didn't understand anything. There was no meaning for me, nothing. So I would judge that as nothing for the whole.

Yes. You can just fill in that it's not meaningful to you.

Yes. Okay.

[Voice recording audio: recording 2]

[Voice recording audio: recording 7]

[Voice recording audio: recording 14]

[Voice recording audio: recording 21]

Okay. So, based on these recordings, can you describe what would make them more or less meaningful to you? So, what are the characteristics and the context?

Well, for a moment I kind of was divided in the sense that maybe... I know that the question is how meaningful this art is to you, but does this or should this be affecting... If, for example, I think that the second recording, which was in French, if I'm thinking that it's meaningful or should be... Or it felt that it was meaningful to a lot of people, a lot of French people, should that be affecting my way of looking at it? Do you understand what I'm saying?

Yes, I understand.

Because they're asking, is it meaningful to you? Well, I don't understand the meaning, but the second recording, it feels like maybe it's because of the mic, it has some sort of noise or whatever. It feels like this sort of like from a stand, someone, a politician or whatever, like a radical person tries to motivate people about doing like a revolution or whatever. And it feels like it's very meaningful to people, it's quite urgent. And then I would divide it, like, okay, I don't understand. I would say it's not meaningful to me, but it's actually meaningful in the sense that I think that it's meaningful to a lot of French people.

Yes, exactly. Okay. So, and then, so you would say that I think if I understand you correctly, then kind of the idea that it's meaningful to a lot of people, or at least you think it's meaningful to a lot of people makes it at least a bit meaningful to yourself?

Exactly. Yes.

That's interesting. It's not a point I've heard thus far, but that's very interesting.

Yes. I guess it comes with empathy, you know, sometimes I have this tendency to empathize. Yeah. So, I think something about that. So, but when it comes to the native language, I guess, for some reason the politician's speech, I judged it less meaningful. Yeah. So, that was the fourth recording in the politician. I judged it less meaningful than, let's say, about how Easter is spent or how they cook the lamb or whatever. Yes. I don't know, because I'm connected more with, I connect more with this kind of stuff, with tradition and getting all together and cooking or whatever, you know, these traditional stuff.

Yes. So, then you would say the topic, if it's kind of the more personal as well for you, then it's more meaningful. And for the French, the tone of voice was very important and almost the quality of the microphone, even.

Yes. But I guess this comes from, I don't know, maybe documentaries, like when you hear, like, when you see a documentary or somebody from talking about post-war documentaries, you know, whenever usually you have, I don't know, like Hitler or Mussolini doing the speech, the noise, there is a noise in the radio where they were trying to motivate people. This immediately gives you this sort of, psychologically gives you this bad sort of idea of what this period was like. And then you get the feeling that a lot of people were like, there was an urgent situation, but then or whatever, weren't supporting these figures. And it's connected to the quality of the recording, that it was an old recording. Yeah. When I heard that, I was thinking somebody's trying to motivate people or trying to rebel or whatever.

Yes, exactly. So. And maybe a difficult question, but can you describe how the meaningfulness of recording connects to like the difference between personal and

genericness? How meaningfulness is connected to if something actually feels personal or generic, okay?

Okay. Yeah. Yeah. I think in my case, probably they're connected a lot. Yeah. So I need to understand the context and I need to get the meaning to probably judge it as really personal. Yes. So maybe the politician's speech, the brief politician's speech. I couldn't really understand what was happening because I think we cut the recording a bit. So I couldn't, it didn't really finish what he was saying. So I was pretty trying to compute in my brain what his speech was all about. It felt personal, but I would say that I would probably would have judged it a bit more personal if also the meaningfulness was also a bit higher. Yeah. So I think that it would correlate. Yes. I would say that they're really connected. But what I do is I consider those to be like really going in the same direction.

Yeah, exactly. Okay. And could you think of a situation or such situations in which the same voice recording would feel more meaningful in one situation and less meaningful in another? And examples of different situations are, being alone or surrounded by people or at home and in public or feeling homesick or not. Cool. So the exact same recording, right?

Yes. The exact same recording, but the context, the surrounding context changes. So let's say I'm again in Amsterdam, but surrounded by maybe some friends in the park and there is like a speaker that this recording is playing or I'm at home and maybe feeling lonely this recording. It would definitely affect me. Yes. I would probably not process it as much in the first case if I'm surrounded by people. Maybe even don't notice it. But at home I would process it in a far different manner. Of course, the context is where you put me, it's definitely going to be affected how I would have judged it. Yeah. As meaningful or personal.

Yes. Okay. Okay. And then for the final kind of variable, I'm going to go to the actual supportiveness of a voice recording. And then I mean, if the recording is in any way just supportive for you for coping with homesickness or maybe even it would damage the homesickness. So it would worsen the homesickness and to what extent. So first of all, if you would think about voice recordings in general again, in which ways do you think certain voice recordings could impact it either positively or negatively? And why?

In which way voice recordings could impact this feeling of homesickness?

Yes. So how they could impact it, what would be characteristics of recordings that would?

I think thinking about it now, it would probably be if there is some information being shared about the situation occurring back at home. Yes. So if it's the invalid

recording about Easter, which is how they cook the lamb or whatever, that felt to improve the state or sort of like making me feel, not more, I wouldn't say more homesick, but it was sort of like, it was a calming effect. It was sort of giving me this image that I was maybe craving, okay, something come home. Yeah. I would think that this kind of information, like sharing things that are part of my home city or home country, my country would ease my feeling of home city.

Yes.

The French on the other hand or Dutch, you could have also chosen Dutch because I don't speak Dutch. That would probably worsen it yeah. It would create the feeling of loneliness even more or de-attachment, how do you say that? I don't know if it's a word. De-attachment. I think so. Yes. Yes. So I would say right now it's not topic wise, but just if I am familiar with the language would work. Yeah.

Yeah. Okay. Um, so I'm going to go back to the questionnaire for the final time. And then I'm going to let you hear the same recordings for the final time. And you can rate them based on how supportive you think they are for coping with homesickness or not.

Uh huh.

And then after hearing the recordings, you can submit the questionnaire. Then I can connect the answers. All right. Are you ready?

Yes.

[Voice recording audio: recording 1]

[Voice recording audio: recording 2]

[Voice recording audio: recording 7]

[Voice recording audio: recording 14]

[Voice recording audio: recording 21]

So based on these recordings, once again, what do you think are the characteristics that make it more or less supportive?

I think it's connected purely to if it's causing this sort of like meaningfulness, If I don't understand the language I wouldn't say it supports me, even though the second French recording. I didn't think that it would support my homesickness. But in the other recordings, I think that the last recording especially would definitely support my homesickness, which was connected to tradition or how things are happening in a specific period. The politician's speech would be somewhat supportive, but I wouldn't judge it to be super supportive in terms of homesickness. Because I then immediately connected to maybe the reasons why I left home, which is about like,

how the situation in my home country is not working and how the politicians are handling it. So I would say it's maybe even this process may be happening in my head.

Yeah.

judge it as supportive, but maybe it has even a negative effect now that I'm thinking about it. But I would say just because I was hearing a Greek politician speak, I would say somewhat supportive. The one about the weather was okay supportive, not so much as the traditional things, like with the lamb cooking. So of course it's connected to.. I don't know if I noticed the way that it was being related. So I was really focusing on what was being said.

Yeah

So I was really focusing on what was being said, so.. that's why through all of this interview I think it's more about what is being said in my language. For the French it was opposite, more about how it was being said.

Okay, and finally I would like you to imagine a voice recording of someone very close to you, so a loved one, a family member, friend, and they are speaking to you directly and about something personal. If you were to imagine this maybe you have a specific thing that comes to mind, how meaningful would that be to you and how supportive for coping with homesickness do you think it would be?

I think at least for me, in my case, now I'm thinking about it, it's meaningfulness or what is being transmitted to me. If I feel attached to it, so not only understanding it, but if I feel attached to that message, it would probably support the homesickness in the sense that I don't have this feeling of now that I'm far away that I'm being attached to some things that are happening there. It's a bit weird, it's not that I think it's not that it would cause this opposite effect of oh it's meaningful to me so I miss home or whatever, it's mostly that I connect with it and I'm like okay I'm not missing out because I got some stuff or I got a gossip or I got something that kind of like fills a bit the holes so that I can continue living here and do what I do. It would definitely be supportive.

Yes, okay. Yeah, so maybe it would make you, it wouldn't make you like miss home more, it would kind of make you more appreciate what you have there and then give you more motivation to continue here?

Exactly. Yes. It's because I think it's connected that I have a plan in my head and I have to be on site for some time and it's like that, but it would definitely feel that it's important if I hear it. Yeah. Like meaningful recording.

Yes, exactly. Okay. And is there anything that you think we haven't covered about recordings, homesickness, anything at all that we haven't shared yet that you would like to share?

Maybe in the first part you asked me the first, the very first question about home. Yes. What is home? And it's just, I'm trying to maybe a follow up question that would be like why that is, like, why did I choose that place or why did I say that? Was it something, because I already had someone in mind when I said that. That's a, I think it's a synthetic thing that I created in my brain, uh, from stories that I have shared, let's say from my grandfather and my grandmother about my village. I never grew up in that village, but I feel so connected to that through stories and stuff that was being shared to me throughout when I was a child and even like right before, uh, they died like 10 years ago, whatever. I also connected to this area because of all the stories. I think it's something that I created out there.

Yeah, exactly.

What was being shared to me, how, how, how, that was created, synthesized.

Yes. Thank you. Thank you so much for that.

Maybe, maybe you could add that also as an extra question.

Maybe I could. Yes.

Like why do you think that is the problem? I don't know if it puts them in the spot, you know, for me, I don't mind being asked this.

Yeah. I can always ask if they don't mind and if, if they do, then they don't have to share. That's okay. Of course.

Okay.

So if you, uh, if you could think of anything, uh, any, any one voice recording, um, that you could think of, um, um, that would be very helpful for you for alleviation of homesickness. Uh, if you are willing to share, what do you think it would be?

What voice would it be?

Yes. Just what type of recording, or if it's from someone specifics about some specific topic?

I could think multiple people, uh, probably just to give a context report, which can be either a friend of mine. Yeah. Uh, maybe even the voice of my partner sharing

something that is related to something that has occurred. Uh, for example, a good, a good example is yesterday, my father called me and he told me like an avocado tree that we have in my garden or whatever there at, uh, our house. Yes. Actually started burying, uh, bearing, uh, bearing avocados. Uh, and that kind of supported me, something that I really liked. Yeah. Uh, so I don't know if it was the actual message of the avocado thing, or if it was the voice of my father. Uh, I think maybe both. Yeah. Uh, but I would say, yeah, if it's from a person that I consider to be familiar or trust or within my circle and sharing something that is maybe like, uh, uh, maybe sharing something that is from every day, something that has occurred, maybe even, ah, I met this girl, like from a friend of mine. Uh And, uh, that could even do that, you know.

Yes. An everyday thing that's being shared by someone that you care about.

Exactly.

Yeah. Okay.

Not a simple routine thing, you know, like, not even routine, well maybe even routine, yeah. Yeah. Yeah. Something about work, whatever. Maybe even gossip, you know. Gossip is also something that helps.

Yeah.

In small cities, or at least like where I'm from, which is a very close society, we, gossip is something that we used to survive the winter, you know?

Yes.

I know it can be bad, because sometimes you share things that are, why are you sharing these things? I know that Gossip has also this negative stigma, but sometimes it's sort of like, uh, it's a way to survive, uh, maybe a difficult situation where it's cold, people are not outside and you're like, oh, that's hard.

Yeah. I can understand that. Yeah. Um, all right. Yeah. That was basically everything. So thank you so much. I'm just gonna turn off the recording now.